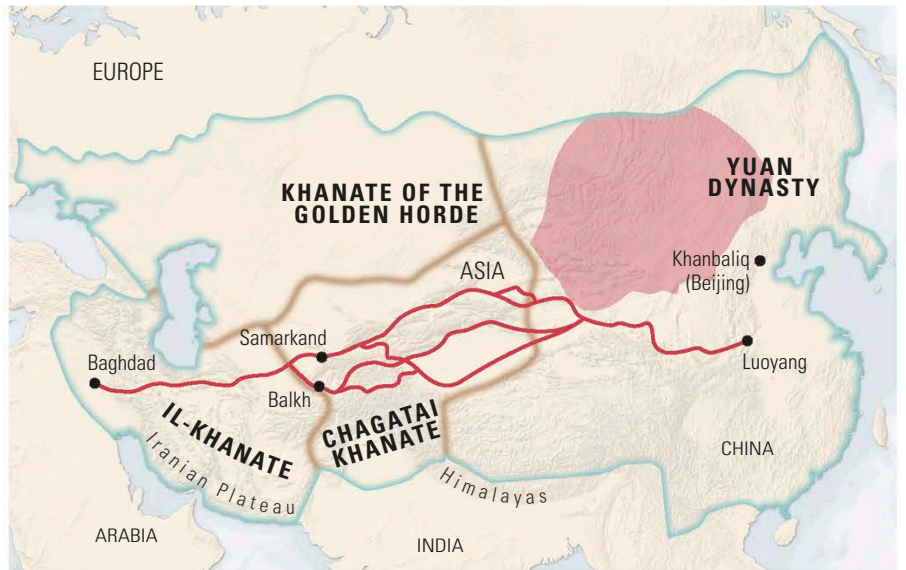


THE EMPIRE ►

At its peak, the Mongol Empire covered an area of 9 million sq miles (23 million sq km). The empire was divided into four parts by the end of the 13th century—the Yuan Dynasty, which ruled China, the Khanate of the Golden Horde in eastern Europe, the Chagatai Khanate comprising modern-day Afghanistan and northwest India, and the Il-Khanate, which covered Persia (modern-day Iran). Extending west to east across the empire was the important trade route known as the Silk Road.

- KEY**
- Mongol homeland c. 1206
 - Greatest extent of Mongol Empire c. 1294
 - Khanate borders
 - The Silk Road



◀ MONGOL WARRIORS

The Mongol army was made up of skilled warriors who fought on horseback, and were taught from a young age how to use a bow and arrow. They were known for their speed and aggression and attacked in large groups, overwhelming their enemies with ease. Riders could travel many miles a day across deserts and mountains.



▼ KUBLAI KHAN

Kublai Khan (reigned 1260–1294) completed his grandfather's conquest of China and founded the Yuan Dynasty (1271–1368), making Khanbaliq (modern-day Beijing) his capital. He encouraged trade along the Silk Road and was tolerant to foreign religions such as Buddhism and Islam.

SORGHAGHTANI BEKI

The youngest daughter-in-law of Genghis Khan, Sorghaghtani (1190–1252) served as an advisor to his successors and became one of the most powerful women in the empire. She encouraged the expansion of trade, and influenced decisions so that all four of her sons eventually came into power.



TIMUR THE CONQUEROR ▼

Timur (reigned 1370–1405) was a ruthless military leader from Central Asia who dreamed of rebuilding Genghis Khan's vast empire. After gaining control of the Chagatai Khanate, he founded the Timurid Empire in 1370, and went on to conquer a vast area that stretched from modern-day Turkey to northern India. He is buried in the Gur-e-Amir tomb (below) in his capital city of Samarkand, Uzbekistan.

The roof of the mausoleum is covered in a mosaic of blue tiles.

